title: "Privacy and Dignity Policy" version: "1.0" effectiveDate: "[Insert Date]" reviewDate: "[Insert Date – usually annually]" appliesTo: "All staff, residents, volunteers, contractors, and visitors at [INSERT CARE HOME NAME]"

Privacy and Dignity Policy

1. Policy Statement

At [INSERT CARE HOME NAME], we are committed to ensuring that all residents are treated with the utmost respect for their privacy and dignity at all times. We recognise that maintaining privacy and dignity is a fundamental human right and central to providing compassionate, person-centred care.

We aim to:

- Protect residents' privacy in all aspects of daily life and care
- Support residents to maintain dignity, independence, and choice
- Ensure that staff understand and uphold the values of respect, compassion, and sensitivity in every interaction

2. Purpose

The purpose of this policy is to:

- Set out principles and standards for protecting resident privacy and dignity
- Ensure staff provide care that maintains respect, independence, and confidentiality
- Comply with the Health and Social Care Act 2008, CQC Fundamental Standards, and human rights legislation

3. Scope

This policy applies to:

- All employees and agency staff
- Volunteers and contractors working within the home
- All residents and their visitors

4. Roles and Responsibilities

Registered Manager:

- Ensures staff training includes privacy and dignity principles
- Monitors practice through supervision, audits, and resident feedback
- Addresses any breaches of privacy or dignity promptly

All Staff:

- Treat residents with courtesy, respect, and sensitivity
- Uphold residents' rights to privacy, dignity, and independence in all aspects of care
- Report any concerns about breaches to the Registered Manager

5. Key Principles of Privacy and Dignity

5.1 Privacy

- Knock and wait for permission before entering residents' rooms
- Close doors, curtains, or screens during personal care
- Respect residents' confidential information in line with GDPR and data protection law
- Provide private spaces for personal conversations and family visits

5.2 Dignity

- Address residents by their preferred name and title
- Involve residents in decisions about their care and daily routines
- Support residents to maintain independence in personal care wherever possible
- Respect residents' choices in clothing, appearance, and personal belongings
- Provide culturally sensitive care that respects religious and personal beliefs

5.3 Confidentiality

- Handle all personal and medical information with discretion
- Share information only on a need-to-know basis and with resident consent, unless legally required

5.4 End-of-Life Care

- Provide sensitive, respectful support that honours residents' dignity and wishes
- Ensure privacy and comfort for residents and families during end-of-life care

6. Staff Training and Development

- All staff will receive training in privacy and dignity principles at induction
- Regular refresher training will be provided
- Supervision and appraisals will include reflection on dignity in care practice

7. Monitoring and Audit

- Resident and family feedback will be sought regularly on privacy and dignity
- Observational audits of care practice will be conducted by managers
- Any complaints or concerns will be investigated promptly and lessons learned shared with staff

8. References

- Care Quality Commission (CQC) Fundamental Standards – Regulation 10 (Dignity and Respect)
- Human Rights Act 1998
- Health and Social Care Act 2008 (Regulated Activities) Regulations 2014
- GDPR / Data Protection Act 2018

9. Related Policies

- Safeguarding Adults Policy
- Record Keeping / Confidentiality / GDPR Policy
- Equality, Diversity, and Inclusion Policy
- End-of-Life Care Policy
- Complaints Policy

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